This book assumes that you have Node.js installed. To install Node.js, visit the website at http://nodejs.org and follow the instructions for your system. Once you have Node.js installed, you'll be able to run Node.js from the command line:

```
> node
```

This will land you in the Node.js prompt, into which you can enter raw JavaScript:

```
node> 1 + 2;
// 3
```

To exit, enter Ctrl-C twice:

```
node> <CTRL-C>
// (^C again to quit)
node> <CTRL-C>
>
```

Installing Node.js also installs npm (Node packaged modules), which you'll use for installing packages. Use npm to install CoffeeScript for all users on your system:

```
> npm install –g coffee-script
```

You now have CoffeeScript installed. Enter `coffee` into your command line:

```
> coffee
```

This launches you into a CoffeeScript prompt that will be your constant companion throughout this book. The command has other functionality besides the prompt, which you can see via `--help`:

```
> coffee --help
```

This will list the options. The meaning of particular options is given later in this book where needed, but not all options are covered.